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October 27, 2025

U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services
Texas Service Center
6820 Merrivale Loop
Mesquite, TX 75149-8802

RE: Form I-129 Petition for O-1A Classification
Petitioner: Voltaris Grid Dynamics, Inc.
Beneficiary: Dr. Anselm Ferreira-Duarte
Position: Principal Research Engineer, Storage Safety Systems
Requested Validity: June 1, 2026 through May 31, 2029

Dear Officer:

This firm represents Voltaris Grid Dynamics, Inc. ("Voltaris" or "the Petitioner") in connection with the enclosed Form I-129 petition seeking O-1A classification on behalf of Dr. Anselm Ferreira-Duarte. Dr. Ferreira-Duarte is a research engineer in grid-scale battery safety whose work on early detection of thermal runaway in lithium-iron-phosphate storage arrays has been adopted by operators outside his own employers and has been written into a North American safety standard. This letter sets out the factual and legal basis for the petition and is supported by the exhibits indexed at the end.

1. THE PETITIONER

Voltaris Grid Dynamics, Inc. is a Delaware corporation with its principal place of business at 4180 Harrowgate Parkway, Suite 900, Belmont Ridge, TX 75094. Founded in 2016, Voltaris designs and supplies safety and monitoring systems for utility-scale battery energy storage installations.

As of September 2025, Voltaris employed 312 people, of whom 84 work in research and engineering, and reported audited revenue of USD 96.4 million for fiscal year 2024. Voltaris systems are installed at 61 storage sites across eleven states.

2. THE BENEFICIARY

Dr. Ferreira-Duarte is a citizen of Brazil. He holds a Doctor of Philosophy in Electrical Engineering from the Universidade Metropolitana de Curitiba, conferred in 2015, and a Master of Science in Applied Physics from the same institution, conferred in 2011.

From 2015 to 2021 he was a Senior Research Fellow at the Kessendra Institute of Applied Energetics in São Paulo. From 2021 to the present he has been employed by Voltaris in Belmont Ridge, Texas, most recently as Principal Research Engineer, Storage Safety Systems.

His principal scientific contribution is Drift-Indexed Impedance Spectroscopy ("DIIS"), a measurement technique that identifies the electrochemical signature of an incipient internal short circuit in a lithium-iron-phosphate cell from small drifts in the cell's impedance response, before any temperature rise is observable at the module surface. He is also the lead author of HeliosGuard, the open detection model that applies DIIS across a full storage array.

3. THE OFFERED POSITION

Voltaris offers Dr. Ferreira-Duarte the position of Principal Research Engineer, Storage Safety Systems, at its Belmont Ridge, Texas research facility, for the period June 1, 2026 through May 31, 2029. The executed employment agreement is submitted at Exhibit F. The position is a continuation of work in his area of extraordinary ability. The agreement provides an annual base salary of USD 268,000, a signing bonus of USD 45,000, and a restricted stock grant.

4. LEGAL STANDARD

Section 101(a)(15)(O)(i) of the Act provides for classification of a person who has extraordinary ability in the sciences, demonstrated by sustained national or international acclaim. Under 8 CFR 214.2(o)(3)(iii), extraordinary ability may be shown by evidence of a major, internationally recognized award, or by at least three of the eight forms of evidence enumerated at 8 CFR 214.2(o)(3)(iii)(B). Dr. Ferreira-Duarte satisfies five.

5. CRITERIA SATISFIED

5.1 NATIONALLY OR INTERNATIONALLY RECOGNIZED PRIZES OR AWARDS — (B)(1)

In 2024 Dr. Ferreira-Duarte received the Halvorsen Medal in Energy Storage Engineering from the Continental Society for Energy Storage Engineering. The award evidence packet at Exhibit C contains the governing bylaws, the published selection criteria, the composition and qualifications of the selection panel, the number and geographic origin of nominations in the 2024 cycle, the list of recipients since 1998, and press coverage of the conferral in trade and general press. The original citation, issued in Portuguese, is at Exhibit C-4, with an English summary prepared by this firm.

5.2 ORIGINAL SCIENTIFIC CONTRIBUTIONS OF MAJOR SIGNIFICANCE — (B)(5)

DIIS and HeliosGuard are original contributions whose significance is documented at Exhibits B-1, B-2 and D. In particular, the technique has been incorporated into North American Storage Safety Council Standard NASSC 4412-2024, and has been deployed by an operator with no commercial or employment relationship to Voltaris, whose Chief Grid Architect describes the results at Exhibit B-2.

5.3 AUTHORSHIP OF SCHOLARLY ARTICLES — (B)(6)

Dr. Ferreira-Duarte is the author or co-author of nineteen peer-reviewed journal articles and eleven refereed conference papers. Exhibit D lists each publication with full bibliographic detail, the editorial and peer review practice of each venue, and each venue's circulation and database indexing.

5.4 PARTICIPATION AS A JUDGE OF THE WORK OF OTHERS — (B)(4)

Dr. Ferreira-Duarte serves as a peer reviewer for the *Journal of Grid-Scale Storage Systems* and for *Transactions on Electrochemical Systems Engineering*, and was appointed in 2023 to the national grant review panel of the Meridian Foundation for Applied Energy Research. The reviewer acknowledgement issued by the *Journal of Grid-Scale Storage Systems* is reproduced at Exhibit D, Part 4.

5.5 HIGH SALARY OR OTHER SIGNIFICANTLY HIGH REMUNERATION — (B)(8)

The compensation package at Exhibit F — base salary of USD 268,000, a signing bonus of USD 45,000, and a restricted stock grant of 14,000 shares vesting over four years — reflects Dr. Ferreira-Duarte's standing in the field.

6. CONCLUSION

For the reasons stated, the Petitioner respectfully requests approval of the petition and classification of the Beneficiary as O-1A for the period requested. Please direct any correspondence to the undersigned.

Respectfully submitted,

Corinne Ashby-Meloy
Corinne Ashby-Meloy, Esq.
Meloy & Trant LLP
Counsel for the Petitioner

INDEX OF EXHIBITS

| Exhibit | Document |

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| A | Form I-129 with O and P Classification Supplement; filing fee; beneficiary passport biographic page; Form I-94 record |

| B-1 | Opinion letter of Prof. Elenora Hargrove-Sittig, Winterbourne Polytechnic University, dated October 9, 2025 |

| B-2 | Opinion letter of Dr. Rasheed Olubanjo-Vance, Pallanton Municipal Power Authority, dated October 14, 2025 |

| C | Award evidence packet — Halvorsen Medal in Energy Storage Engineering (2024) |

| C-4 | Original award citation, Portuguese language, with English summary prepared by counsel

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| D | Publication and citation summary, with reviewer acknowledgement at Part 4 |

| E | Doctoral and master's diplomas and academic transcripts, Universidade Metropolitana de Curitiba |

| F | Executed employment agreement between Voltaris Grid Dynamics, Inc. and Dr. Anselm Ferreira-Duarte, dated September 30, 2025 |